Ayub had assured Khan that any 'fleeing birds' would contact him if they survived a month. In the first week of November, Khan received a visitor. It was Ariz alias Zunaid, who had crossed to Nepal from Jogbani in Araria district, Bihar. Nizam Khan gave him a new identity—Mohammed Salim from Ward No. 18, Birat Nagar, Nepal, and managed to get him accommodation at a madrassa.

Zunaid was not the first fugitive terrorist to be welcomed in Nepal. Since the mid 1990s, the ISI with the help of underworld don Da-wood Ibrahim had successfully raised a solid network in the Himalayan country, charged with carrying out anti-India operations including smuggling. This had partly been made possible by India's big brother attitude to Nepal, which created a strong feeling of resentment in the Himalayan country.

For the R&AW, Nepal is the perfect example of both the triumph and the failure of traditional spying. The Himalayan nation was once an excellent theatre for Indian operatives, where top assets had been recruited to eliminate actual and potential threats. These assets close to the people in power provided quality intelligence, more useful and effective than any surveillance and sophisticated monitoring of second rung officers in a government.

But political failures on the part of various Indian governments led to a situation where India does not have the influence over Nepal it ought to have and did have in the 1950s, when the first ever treaty of peace and friendship between India and Nepal had been signed by C.P.N. Singh, the then India's ambassador to Nepal and Shamsher Jang Bahadur Rana, the maharaja, prime minister and supreme com-mander-in-chief of Nepal.